Nishen Madava

Cybersecurity Undergraduate · Aspiring Penetration Tester / SOC Analyst

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Hack The Box profile Sri Lanka



PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

BSc (Hons) Cyber Security undergraduate at SLTC Research University who completed a six-month cybersecurity internship at CodeZela, designing and building a Wazuh SOC monitoring lab on AWS and proving four detection use cases end-to-end with captured evidence. Active CTF competitor (Team N4X, 5th place nationally at ANIMUS 1.0) across web security, digital forensics, OSINT and network security, with a full-stack development background that supports secure coding. Seeking a cybersecurity internship in SOC operations, penetration testing or security engineering.

EXPERIENCE

Cybersecurity Intern · CodeZela

Apr 2026 – Sep 2026

Six-month internship (completed) · Capstone project: SOCWatch · github.com/nishenmadawa15-collab/SOCWatch

- Designed and built **SOCWatch**, a Wazuh SOC monitoring lab on AWS, provisioning the VPC, security groups and IAM, enforcing root MFA and configuring budget alerts.
- Deployed a Wazuh manager (server, indexer and dashboard, v4.14.7) and enrolled three endpoints (Ubuntu, Debian, Windows Server 2022) with all agents reporting as active.
- Proved four detection use cases end-to-end with captured evidence: centralised log ingestion, file integrity monitoring (create/modify/delete with hash diffs), CVE-feed vulnerability detection, and authentication-failure/brute-force detection using single and correlated rules.
- Captured and documented a genuine internet-sourced brute-force attempt against the lab during evidence collection, validating the correlation rules against real-world traffic.
- Authored the full project report, operational runbook, presentation deck and weekly evidence log.

PROJECTS

SOCWatch · Wazuh SOC monitoring lab on AWS

Complete

github.com/nishenmadawa15-collab/SOCWatch

- Wazuh SIEM deployment on AWS monitoring Linux and Windows Server endpoints: log ingestion, file integrity monitoring, vulnerability and brute-force detection (full detail under Experience).

STACK Wazuh · AWS (EC2, VPC, IAM) · Linux · Windows Server

FLAGVORA · CTF platform — "Find the flaw. Earn the flag."

In development

- Original CTF platform brand built on the open-source GZ::CTF core (AGPLv3) with custom patches.
- Work includes security hardening, admin two-factor authentication, a dedicated admin application and a deployment kit. Private repository.

STACK C# · Python

NexSkill · Skill-based internship matching platform (SLTC team project, CCS2360)

Team project

github.com/nishenmadawa15-collab/nexskill

- Built an explainable weighted match score (skills 45%, GPA 20%, preferences 15%, year 10%, certifications 10%) with three-tier skill similarity, including a from-scratch TF-IDF cosine similarity, and a skill-gap analyser.
- Enforced Row-Level Security on every database table; evaluation achieved 90% precision and recall.

STACK Next.js · React · Supabase (PostgreSQL) · Tailwind CSS

Secure E-Commerce Platform · Southern Plant Nursery

In development

- Full-stack store with WhatsApp-first ordering and separate customer, admin and careers portals.
- Security controls: OTP login, role-separated portals, time-limited file links, Zod input validation, Prisma parameterised queries and migration preflight checks. Private repository.

STACK Next.js · TypeScript · Prisma · MySQL · Tailwind CSS

Privacy-first browser tools · Four Chrome extensions and BG Remover — Published

github.com/nishenmadawa15-collab/bg-remover · live demo

- Gramo (grammar/spelling helper), YouTube Timestamp Saver, AdBlock Pro and Window Resizer: zero personal data collected, no tracking, settings stored locally and a public privacy policy for each.
- BG Remover: client-side background removal for solid-colour backgrounds using canvas colour keying with adjustable sensitivity and transparent PNG export; images never leave the browser.

STACK JavaScript · Chrome Extensions API · HTML Canvas

CTF COMPETITIONS & ACHIEVEMENTS

5th place nationally — ANIMUS 1.0 CTF, University of Ruhuna (CSSC + VULNHAT) — 2025

Team N4X (SLTC) · Domains: Web, Digital Forensics, Cryptography, Reverse Engineering, OSINT, Network Security

- **DEADFACE CTF 2026 "Operation Kingmaker"** — Cyber Hacktics, Oct 2026. International CTF with hundreds of teams worldwide; competed as VoidInjector with teammate VAMP_07 (competitor badge).
- **IIT CTF Challenge** — 2025 · **CyberQuest CTF** — NSBM Green University, 2025 · **CYPHER 4.0** — IEEE Student Branch, Kotelawala Defence University (first CTF).
- Ongoing hands-on practice on **Hack The Box** and **TryHackMe** labs.

EDUCATION

BSc (Hons) Cyber Security · SLTC Research University — 2024 – 2028 (expected)

Sri Lanka Technological Campus · Relevant coursework: Network Security, Ethical Hacking, Cryptography, Cyber Forensics, Security Policies & Risk Management

Foundation in Cyber Security · CICRA Campus — 2023 – 2024

Diploma in Cyber Security · SITC Campus

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

- **Google Cybersecurity Certificate courses (Coursera)**, Mar 2026 — Play It Safe: Manage Security Risks · Connect and Protect: Networks and Network Security · Tools of the Trade: Linux and SQL · Assets, Threats, and Vulnerabilities
- **Certificate in Cyber Security & Ethical Hacking (C|CSEH)**
- **DEADFACE CTF 2026 Competitor** — Cyber Hacktics, Oct 2026
- **E|Hacking Workshop V02** — hands-on ethical hacking workshop · **ISACA Cyber Camp** — University of Sri Jayewardenepura

SKILLS

Security	SOC monitoring & SIEM (Wazuh), log analysis, file integrity monitoring, vulnerability assessment, web application security (OWASP Top 10, SQLi, XSS), penetration testing methodology, network traffic analysis, digital forensics, OSINT, risk assessment, secure coding
Tools	Kali Linux, Burp Suite, Nmap, Wireshark, Metasploit, Nessus, OWASP ZAP, Wazuh
Cloud & systems	AWS (EC2, VPC, IAM, security groups), Linux (Ubuntu, Debian), Windows Server
Programming & web	Python, C/C++, JavaScript, TypeScript, SQL, React, Next.js, Node.js, Tailwind CSS, Supabase, Prisma, MySQL
Soft skills	Analytical thinking, problem solving, teamwork, communication, leadership
Languages	Sinhala, English

LEADERSHIP & COMMUNITY

- **Publicity & PR Director** — ISACA Student Group, SLTC: organises cyber-awareness initiatives, CTF challenges and technical workshops.
- **Member** — SLTC LEO Club: community service and leadership activities.